



YOU ARE **8 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

219 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The development of the baby's lower limbs always lags slightly behind that of the upper limbs. At this stage, the toes are not distinct and the legs are not yet bending at the knee.

“It's understandable that your pregnancy will be on your mind. Try to find ways to communicate this to your partner.”

Going through pregnancy together is momentous, and at a time when you want to feel close to your partner, you may find that your relationship is changing, and it may be quite fraught with issues. Your relationship will inevitably change—but as long as you keep communicating, you will be able to support each other. Being united now will stand you in good stead for the first year of parenting.

During the early stages of pregnancy, your partner may find it hard to relate to the fact that you're expecting a baby; the physical changes to your body won't be that visible at this stage and there won't be a scan photo yet. Conversely, you will be very aware of the pregnancy and undergoing many physical and emotional changes.

Your partner may need more time than you to adjust to the idea of being a parent and may be concerned about practical issues, such as the changes to your lifestyle and the financial implications of having a baby. Talking openly to each other can help ease anxieties for you both. Remember, that although many changes are happening to your body, your partner does have feelings and this is a big life change. If you've told your family and close friends about the pregnancy, all the attention may be on you. Your partner may be feeling left out and this is something that often gets worse as the pregnancy progresses and after the baby arrives.

Look for ways to involve your partner more in the pregnancy and encourage them to spend time with friends who have been through the expectant partner experience.